

however, we remain watchful of the evolving situation. After a brief interruption, a large majority of our retail sales force and distributors have now resumed operations.”

Adani Wilmar operates in the country through Bangladesh Edible Oil Ltd (BOEL), which is one of the leading players in the burgeoning branded edible oil market there. It sells 30,700 tonnes of palm oil every year and is also now marketing Adani Wilmar’s flagship brands like Fortune (rice bran oil) and King’s (sunflower oil).

Beyond the challenges, Pandey of NIPFP highlights that the turmoil also presents an opportunity as several international buyers of apparel from

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Bangladesh could shift to India. Bangladesh imports yarn and fabric from India and is a major exporter of apparel.

CareEdge Ratings said recently that if the turmoil continues, around 10% of Bangladesh’s ready-made garment goods export orders could shift, and this can present monthly export opportunities of \$200-250 million in the near term and \$300-350 million in the medium term for India.

While it’s still early days, hopes are that the crisis will not drag on since Bangladesh is facing economic challenges as well. **BT**

(With inputs from Arnab Dutta, Richa Sharma and Surabhi)

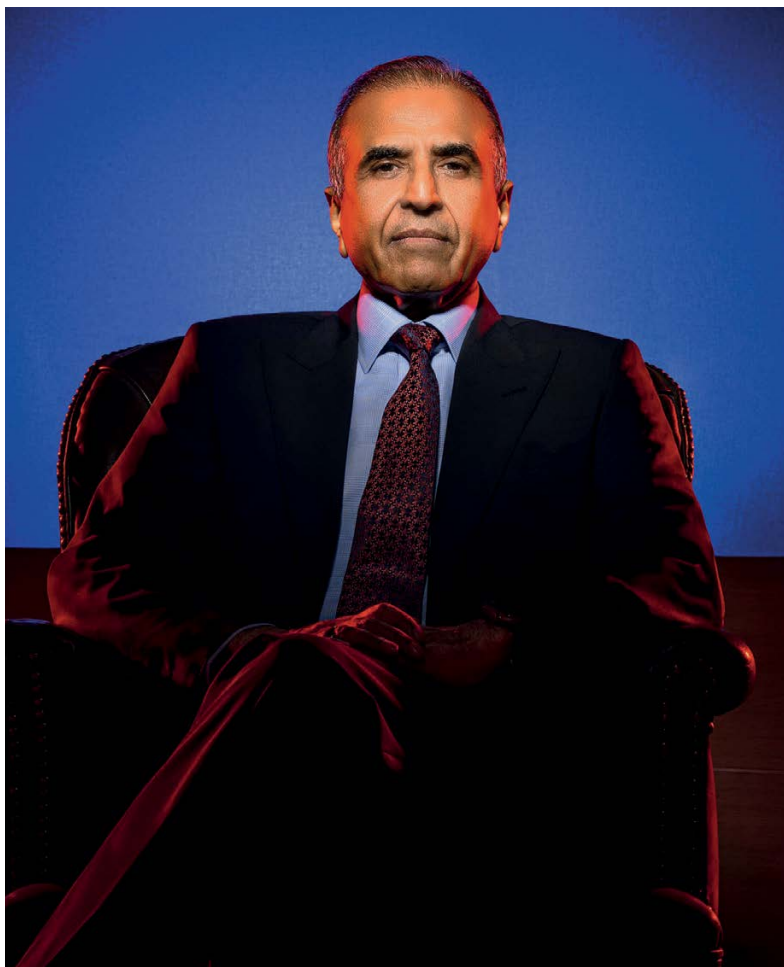
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TELECOM

Dialing the Future

Acquiring a 24.5% stake in BT Group will help Bharti Global pick up key insights on 5G

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN • PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH



LONG DISTANCE CALL Analysts tracking the sector believe that Sunil Bharti Mittal-led Bharti Enterprises is clearly taking a long-term view of the investment in BT Group

► **IN BUSINESS, LIFE** comes full circle more often than not. In 1997, British Telecom picked up a 21% stake in Bharti Airtel, before exiting that investment in 2001. After

more than 20 years, Bharti Global, the international investment arm of Bharti Enterprises, is set to acquire a 24.5% stake from Altice UK—the leading investor in the